

Setting expectations

Although functional programming has a profound impact on the way we write software at every level, it takes time to build up to that. It's an incremental process. Don't expect to be blown away by how amazing functional programming is right in the first chapter. The principles laid out in the beginning are quite subtle, and may even seem like they're just common sense. If you think to yourself "that's something I can already do without knowing FP," then that's great! That's exactly the point. Most programmers are already doing FP to some extent, without even knowing it. Many things that most people consider to be best practices (like making a function have only a single responsibility, or making data immutable) are implied by accepting the premise of functional programming. We are simply taking the principles underlying those best practices and carrying them all the way to their logical conclusion.

It's highly likely that in reading this book, you will simultaneously learn both Scala syntax and functional programming. As a result, at first it may seem to you that the code looks very alien, the techniques are unnatural, and the exercises are brain-bending. That is perfectly normal. Do not be deterred. If you get stuck, look at the hints and answers,¹ or take your questions to the Google Group (<https://groups.google.com/forum/#!topic/scala-functional/>) or the IRC channel (#fp-in-scala on irc.freenode.net).

Above all, we hope that this book will be a fun and rewarding experience for you, and that functional programming makes your work easier and more enjoyable as it has done for us. This book's purpose, when all is said and done, is to help you be more productive in your work. It should make you feel less like the software you are writing is a collection of dirty hacks, and more like you are creating a thing of beauty and utility.

Author Online

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¹ <https://github.com/fpinscala/fpinscala>.